



Misa Guitar Surface

Misa Digital Guitar surface is an electric guitar with buttons instead of strings and is based on Linux

Cantata

The Cantata is a digital preamp/DAC that includes a built-in CD player and networking for external NAS drives or computers



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If you plug your iPod into a USB port and use its Disk Mode functionality, it gets recognised as a mass storage device where you can still copy your files onto it, but it won't play them. This happens because iPod uses a song Database called the iTunesDB to recognise the files stored in it. If you explore your iPod contents under the disk mode you will notice many folders named in a sequence such as F00, F01 and F02 with randomly named MP3 files.

If you manually transfer a song from your computer to your iPod, this directory structure is destroyed and the files are stored in a rather random pattern. This is precisely why you need an iPod manager (iTunes) to share music between your iPod and PC. The reason for such a distribution is not officially disclosed and the guesstimates run from avoiding casual piracy to speed and efficiency gains.

Many users find iTunes too bloated for their needs and hence we now explore a couple of alternative iPod managers for both Windows and Linux Platform.

MediaMonkey

MediaMonkey is available in the Free and Gold version. The Free version is amply able and the Gold version only includes minor enhancements in the area of Disk Burning, MP3 encoding and Folder Monitoring.

It supports syncing content with all generations

iPod Survival Guide

The iPod is one of the most sought after PMPs around. We look at alternatives suites, especially if you use a non-proprietary OS and don't have iTunes

of iPod including the very latest iPod Touch (1st, 2nd and 3rd Generation) and the iPhone (2G, 3G and 3GS including the 3.x firmware). One interesting feature of note is that it can level volume of the tracks while syncing and will hence play at one normalised volume even on your iPod. MediaMonkey also has a dedicated feature for downloading and managing your podcast subscription. It can even sync it with your devices. One limitation regarding iPod support is, as with many other media players, that it needs iTunes installed on your system to detect your iPod (especially iPhone/iPod Touch)

one is auto-fetching of missing ID3 tag information from internet databases including CD covers. The second way is manual update, MediaMonkey has a full featured tag editor with a very intuitive interface. Complete ID3 tag information is very important from the Point of view of playing your music on your iPod because it stores and searches them based on the meta data only as your directory structure is eliminated.

In terms of playback support MediaMonkey doesn't disappoint one bit. It belongs to the class of players which play anything you throw at them from MP3



A rock solid Windows based alternative for iTunes with a clean and intuitive interface

as it uses the same device drivers. You don't need to use iTunes, but it should be merely present on your system.

One fun feature it boasts of is "Party Mode" where basically your player runs in kiosk mode. So your guests can play/request songs themselves without modifying your playlist, supporting this feature is the Auto-DJ, which automatically selects tracks to play once the playlist runs out.

If you own a collection of more than 5,000 songs collected from various sources you have obviously faced the problem of incomplete ID3 tags. MediaMonkey handles this in two awesome ways,

to FLAC and everything in between. So if you are looking at a Windows-based alternative to replace iTunes as your iPod manager and media player, MediaMonkey offers itself as a rock solid alternative with loads of options of customisation via plug-in support. It's feature rich and has a snappy interface even with dealing with huge collections. If you can live with limited disc burning and ripping support, look no further for an alternative to iTunes.

SongBird

This is a cross platform solution and works well on both Linux, Windows and even Mac. It has been made on the same core as Mozilla Firefox, and that itself is reason enough to be excited about this

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